College of Arts and Sciences

COLLEGE OF ARTS AND SCIENCES (CAS)

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History and Overview

RHU's College of Arts and Sciences (CAS) is uniquely positioned to meet the growing need in Lebanon for education, language, media, computer science, math, and design fields. We focus on graduating 21st-century professionals who excel in their fields and contribute significantly to their communities. CAS graduates have the opportunity to play pivotal roles in advancing civil society and raising civic awareness. We are committed to developing students' leadership skills and empowering them to make a real difference in the community.

At the College of Arts and Sciences, our faculty members are not just researchers; they are practitioners in their varied fields. They bring their hands-on professional experience into the classroom, enriching our students' learning. Our faculty members' publications, including books, academic journal articles, conference papers, magazine and newspaper articles, broadcast media scripts, and more, are a testament to their expertise and commitment to their disciplines.

Vision

The College of Arts and Sciences (CAS) aims to provide excellent educational standards, purposeful research, and interdisciplinary investigation into present and future problems facing humanity in Lebanon, the MENA region, and the World.

Mission

As educators committed to Rafik Hariri University, our mission in the College of Arts and Sciences is to provide students with a holistic, integrated education across the arts, English, humanities, social sciences, design, math, sciences, and computing. We are

dedicated to excellence in teaching, scholarly work, academic quality, professional programs, technological innovations, and friendly faculty-student relationships. We prepare our graduates to be highly productive in their prospective careers.

Core Values

The College of Arts and Sciences is committed to acting by the following guiding values:

Professional Excellence
We, faculty and students alike, strive to consistently do our utmost to reach high standards of excellence in our performance.

Collaboration
We value and benefit from each other's unique perspectives by engaging in mutual respect. We share expertise, resources, and time to pursue common goals.

Integrity
We are committed to transparent decision-making in all College of Arts and Sciences processes. We insist on treating every faculty member, staff member, and student fairly and compassionately.

Celebration
We recognize, appreciate, and celebrate the achievements of all members of the College of Arts and Sciences (faculty, students, and staff).

Compassion
We are concerned about the whole person and their well-being, whether they are within our college or the greater community. That concern translates into compassionate actions towards individuals and the larger community.

Innovative Teaching
We engage faculty and students in innovative teaching methodologies, including the effective use of technology.

Learning Objectives

Students in the College of Arts and Sciences will:

Develop professional background and skills in their chosen fields.
Students will become proficient in theory and application relevant to their majors and learn to pursue research in their chosen fields.

Integrate academic learning with community experiences.
Students will apply what they have learned from their workplace experiences to enter their professions with confidence upon graduation.

Value and practice reflective thinking
Students will engage in reflective, critical, and independent thinking.

Develop communication skills
Students will engage in classes that emphasize oral and written communication skills.

Develop personal values
Programs and activities at the college will provide opportunities for students to develop their values by engaging with community social issues.

Develop digital media literacy.
Students will develop the ability to "read" and "write" in today's media, a key skill for all 21st-century citizens.

Academic Programs

The College of Arts and Sciences offers an undergraduate program leading to a Bachelor of Arts (BA) degree and three undergraduate programs leading to a Bachelor of Science (BS) degree. The programs are as follows:

1. Bachelor of Arts in English Language
2. Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (ABET Accredited)
3. Bachelor of Science in Healthcare Information Systems
4. Bachelor of Science in Graphic Design
5. Minors in Computer Science, Data Analytics, Graphic Design, Mathematics, English Language and Literature, and Psychology

Program Codes

The following table lists the code used for each program. This code is the prefix of each course designation in the program.

Program Code	Program
EDUC	Education
ENGL	English Language
COSC	Computer Science
HCIS	Healthcare Information Systems
MATH	Mathematics
GRDS	Graphic Design

Admission Requirements

Students wishing to enter the College of Arts and Sciences must fulfill the University admission requirements. Students aspiring to major in the English language must attain a minimum score of 550 on their English placement test. Students aspiring to study in the Design Department must take an aptitude test to get accepted into the major. Students are strongly advised to review the University Catalog carefully for admission and degree requirements, as well as related academic policies.

Graduation Requirements

Each program in the College of Arts and Sciences grants students a bachelor's degree. The BA program encompasses 93 credits for the English Language. The BS program comprises 93 credits in Computer Science, 100 in Healthcare Information Systems, and 111 in Graphic Design. The credit hour allocations for each program are shown in the following tables:

BA in English Language (93 credits)						
Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	9	-	6	15	30	32
College Requirements	-	-	9		9	10
Program Requirements	27	18	3	6	54	58
Credits	54		39		93	100

BS in Computer Science (93 credits)						
Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	6	–	15	9	30	32
College Requirements	-	–	–	–	-	0
Program Requirements	36	9	18	–	63	68
Credits	42	9	33	9	93	100

BS in Healthcare Information Systems (100 credits)						
Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	9	-	13	9	31	31
College Requirements	-	-	-	-	-	-
Program Requirements	42	9	18	-	69	70
Credits	51	9	31	9	100	100

BS in Graphic Design (111 credits)

Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	12	-	9	9	30	27
College Requirements	-	-	-	-	-	-
Program Requirements	51	6	21	3	81	73
Credits	63	6	30	12	111	100

A student in any of the CAS programs is eligible for graduation if s/he has:

1) Completed all the requirements of the degree
2) Attained a cumulative GPA of 70 or higher
3) Attained a major GPA of 70 or higher
4) Attained at least a 70 grade on the summative learning project/ senior project
5) Completed the mandatory Co-op training program.

I. University Requirements (General Education)

Every RHU student must take 30–33 credit hours of general education courses, distributed across six domains described below. Twenty-one mandatory credits are selected from domains 1, 4, 5, and 6, and 9-12 elective credit hours are selected from domains 2 and 3.

Domain		Credits	Courses
1	Communication Competency*	8	ENGL 210: English Composition and Rhetoric ENGL 217: Professional English Communication ARAB 212**:** Arabic Language and Communication
2	Humanities/Fine Arts	3-6	Selected from an approved list
3	Social Sciences/Culture	6	Selected from an approved list
4	Natural Sciences and Technology	6	Selected from an approved list
5	Quantitative Reasoning	3	Selected from an approved list
6	Community and Sustainability	4	Selected from an approved list

* Refer to the introductory section of the college of interest for a description of courses specific to domains 1, 4, 5, and 6.

Descriptions of the mandatory general education courses are given below:

BITM 200	**Information Technology Essentials**	**3(3,0)**

This course introduces MS Office products (Word, Excel, PPT, and ACCESS), Web page design and server upload, Internet use, and how PCs work.

CMNS 355	**Digital Media Literacy**	**3(3,0)**
The class aims to produce media-literate students who successfully use media to voice their ideas, become better citizens, and engage in social, political, and cultural change. It focuses on how media communicate meanings that influence our perceptions of reality, including our perceptions of ourselves, society, politics, and culture. It teaches students to effectively use critical thinking to deconstruct media messages, analyze and interpret intent, and generate constructive responses. It provides students with essential new media production skills and knowledge to create digital media messages, including digital design, photo manipulation, video/audio production, blogging, podcasting, and screencasting.		

EDUC 222	**Computer Applications in Education**	**3(3,0)**
This course focuses on general knowledge of the use of microcomputers in education, including common computer applications such as word processing, spreadsheet, database, and presentation software in teaching/learning activities, as well as evaluating the effectiveness of educational software in teaching/learning across various subject matter areas.		

EDUC 480	**Special Topics in Education**	**3(3,0)**
This course provides students with advanced study on selected topics or emerging issues in Arab or international education. It is designed for seminar format, multimedia presentation, experiential learning activities, interactive assignments, and cooperative group work. **Prerequisite**: EDUC 201 or consent of advisor.		

ENGL 210	**English Composition and Rhetoric**	**3(3,0)**
This course reviews the fundamentals of good academic writing in English, teaches essay writing essentials and research skills in two rhetorical modes (persuasion and argumentation), and provides practice in writing essays in these modes, research papers, and oral presentations. **Prerequisite:** ENGL 101 or TOEFL 550+ (paper) or 80+ (computer).		

ENGL 217	**Professional English Communication**	**3(3,0)**
This course is designed to help students develop effective professional communication skills, both orally and in writing. In this course, students learn how to write emails, memos, letters, proposals, reports, and other forms of employment correspondence. In addition, this course helps students sharpen their presentation skills. Broadly, this course enables students to behave professionally and effectively in their prospective jobs. **Prerequisite**: ENGL 210.		

ENGL 420	**Literature and Culture**	**3(3,0)**

This course considers major works of literature, specifically in the context of twentieth-century cultural theory, including Marxism, post-colonialism, national literature, ethnic writings, and feminist theory. The primary intention of this course is to explore how various texts interact with their societies or how those societies influence the construction of literary works. **Prerequisite**: Consent of the instructor.

GRDS 220	**Introduction to Digital Media**	**3(3,0)**
In this course, students will develop a solid foundation in the tools and techniques of Adobe Illustrator and Adobe Photoshop. Students will learn the difference between vector-based and pixel-based programs and how to integrate both work fields to produce creative graphics. Moreover, students will receive a brief introduction to Adobe InDesign, including its workspace, functions, and tools.		

GRDS 335	**Production**	**3(3,0)**
In this course, students will develop an understanding of the "process flow" of contemporary print production methods. The course covers the entire production timeline: Prepress, Press, and Postpress. In addition to printing technologies, students will learn about various types of ink and paper, binding, varnishes, finishing techniques, and the effect of the printing process on the product. Students will also learn how to handle projects and deal with clients as freelance designers or as designers working for companies. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 222.		

GRDS 360	**Visual Perception & Infographics**	**3(3,0)**
Visual perception is the ability to interpret information from our surroundings through visible light that reaches the eye. This course will explore the various theories of visual perception with an emphasis on Gestalt theory and its relation to Graphic Design. It will create an understanding of our human visual perception and its limitations. Students will also be given projects in which they will apply Gestalt principles and the theories they have learned. In addition to visual perception theories, students will learn two key design disciplines: Infographics and Wayfinding. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 311.		

GRDS 440	**Design and Social Impact**	**3(3,0)**
This course prepares students to become leading agents of social change through community engagement. It aims to promote collaboration between computer science and graphic design students to develop effective solutions to community issues. The course is structured around a balance of classroom theory, extensive field research, and the implementation of a real-world solution that draws on both. **Prerequisites:** Junior Standing.		

HCIS 201	**Environmental Health**	**3(3, 0)**
This course is designed to provide students with an introduction to the key areas of environmental health. The course will cover factors associated with the development of environmental health problems from population and community perspectives. **Prerequisite***:* None*.*		
INDS 220	**Computer Design I**	**3(3,0)**

This course introduces the principles and applications of computer-aided drafting and design using the latest version of AutoCAD. Students will acquire the technical skills to draft 2D architectural plans, sections, elevations, and details. In addition, students will learn computer-rendering techniques using Adobe Photoshop.

INDS 325	**Lighting & Mechanics**	**3(3,0)**
This course comprehensively studies lighting systems, mechanics, principles, and theories. Students will learn about lighting design applications, lighting specifications, in-depth lighting mathematical calculations, available equipment and fixtures, and aesthetic considerations needed to complete the installation. Students will also become familiar with different heating, ventilation, and AC systems, including their installation, design considerations, and needs, as well as plumbing and sanitary systems. **Prerequisite**: INDS 315.		

INDS 335	**Design Issues and Sustainability**	**3(3,0)**
This course investigates theoretical and philosophical constructs, as well as design issues, related to the study of interior architecture and design. It examines philosophical and practical principles of sustainable design by exploring environmental issues, sustainable materials and methods, and professional practice. Students will develop an awareness of the environmental implications of design decisions. They will gain a foundation for evaluating materials, processes, and practices in accordance with sustainable and environmentally responsible design principles.		

MATH 207	**College Algebra**	**3(3,0)**
Solving linear and non-linear equations, modeling with equations, functions, and their graphs, increasing and decreasing functions-transformation, quadratic functions and minima, modeling with functions, combining functions, polynomial functions and their graphs, dividing polynomials, real zeros of polynomials, complex numbers, complex zeros of polynomials, exponential and logarithmic functions, sequences and summation notation-arithmetic sequences, counting and probability.		

MATH 220	**Statistics for Social & Behavioral Sciences**	**3(3,0)**
This course introduces statistical techniques for analyzing social science research data. Topics include frequency distribution, central tendency, variability, probability theory, Bayes' rule, mathematical expectation, variance and covariance, binomial, Poisson, hypergeometric and normal distributions, sampling distributions, estimation problems, and hypothesis testing. **Prerequisite**: None.		

MATH 351	**Probability and Statistics**	**3(3,0)**
Probability and conditional probability; discrete and continuous random variables; marginal distributions; expectation, variance, mean, median, covariance, and correlation; conditional expectation; Normal distribution; sampling distribution; prediction and confidence intervals; hypothesis testing; and regression line and correlation coefficients. **Prerequisite**: MATH 215.		
PHYS 211	**Physics: Electricity and Magnetism and Lab**	**3(3,1)**